AgriVision4U

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Agriculture Under Single Roof

Consulting Business Development

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With global population increasing rapidly, food and fibre demand with increased awareness of dietary choices has reached greater appetite scale. This transformation and multiplied forage demand has impacted agricultural sector worldwide, giving producers, processors and accumulators larger opportunities for increased productivity and industrial connectivity. Yet, we witness extensive malnourishment, producers whining for right commodity prices, and hence a larger gap between agricultural industry and transformative growth. Embracing this need for connected perspective, agriculture consultants have stepped in the field to drive operational improvements, business potential and chain a strong link by helping customers build sustainable competence within this transformative impact.

Farming companies are only recently warming up to the idea of hiring agriculture consulting companies in India. Agriculture industry accounts for 18% of the national GDP and hires almost 50% of the employable workforce in the country. However, the sector has been lagging in recent years in updating its methods and technology usage. That's where agriculture consulting companies play a large role in the future of Indian agriculture.

Why shall a company hire a consultant?

There are 5 major reasons to hire a consultant for a farming related business.

1. Understand Market Dynamics from The Experts

Although farming may seem like a static business the market dynamics keep changing regularly. What a consultant is supposed to do is provide his extensive knowledge and experience in your field to help you navigate your business problems successfully. Agriculture consultant recommendations are made based on market trends now and for the future. Using the insights derived by the agriculture consultant can help you get an edge over your competitors.

2. Learn New Skills with The Agriculture Consultant

A consultant is an expert in his area. Simply by listening to and paying attention to the way the consultant is working you can gain new skills and knowledge. During the consulting period, you are free to ask the consultant for a breakdown of all the tasks that he/she is doing to help you better understand the thought process behind the decision-making ability. Something that could come in handy at a later stage of your career.

3. Looking at Problems from Other Angles

Another benefit of hiring a farm consulting company to help you with your projects is to have another set of eyes look at your issue. A lot of us tend to only be able to see a problem though one lens. Business owners tend to be too close to their projects for them to

notice the larger problems that could crop up. Hiring a farming consulting company could help you with that issue.

4. Easy to Complete Short Term Goals

The farming process is long term but involves multiple stages. Consider each stage a tiny, short-term goal you would like to achieve. A consulting company can help you realize those short-term goals more effectively and efficiently. Three spheres where a consulting company can help you ace are,

1. Better technology,
2. Better methodology, and
3. Better access to funds.

Realizing short term goals also helps maintain higher levels of motivation on the project.

5. Save Costs by Hiring an Agriculture Consultant

One of the primary reasons for hiring an agriculture consultant is to help save costs. Hiring a farming consulting company does cost money, however, the costs, both direct and indirect, saved due to the feedback provided by the consultant can be huge.

Facets of Agriculture consultancy

Within the agriculture consulting industry, various consulting players specialize in different facets of the industry. The **key to develop a successful agriculture consulting business is to identify the right niche or specialization in which your consulting firm will specialize. This choice shall be based on your inherent strengths** and size of the addressable market.

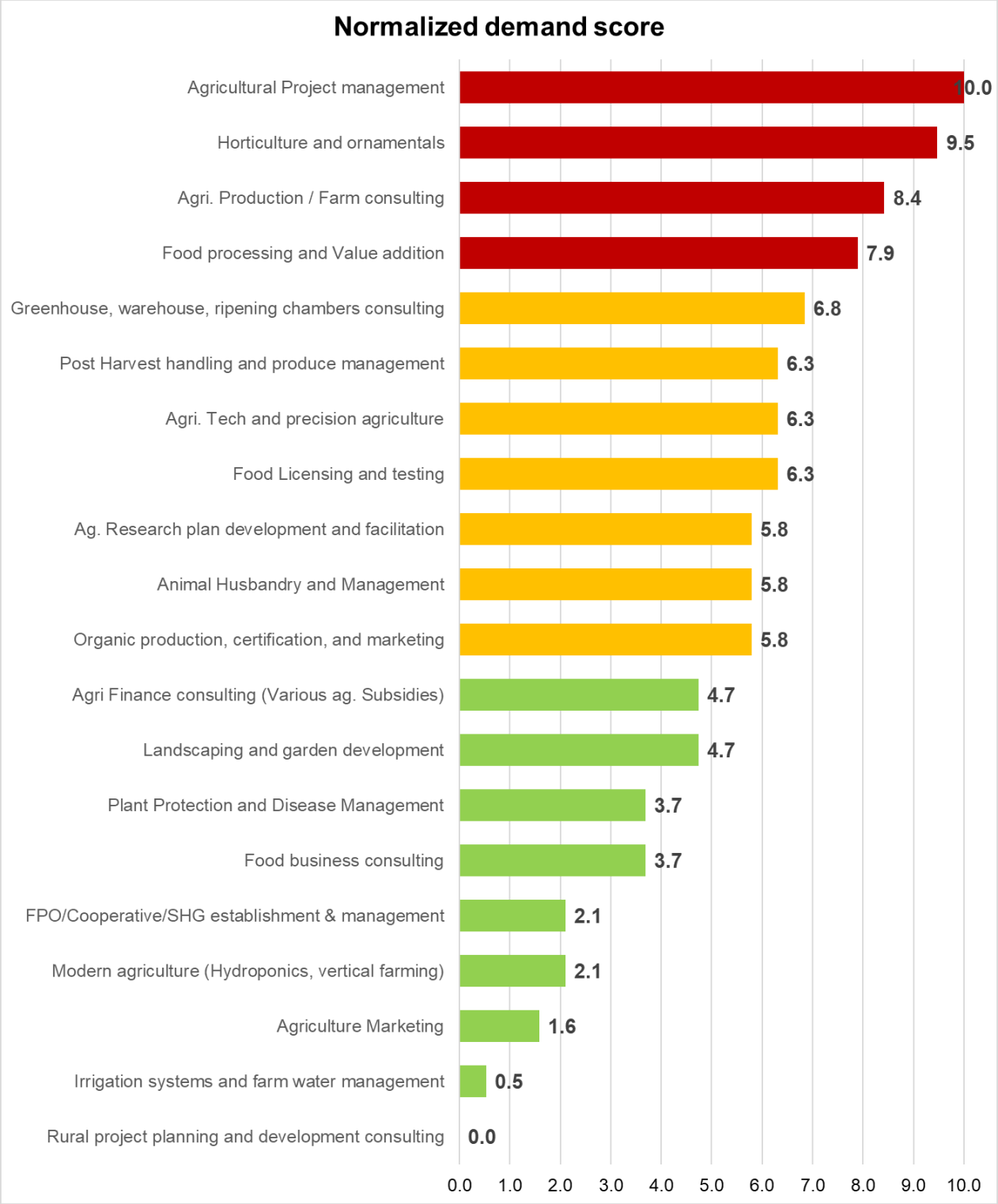
The 20 most in-demand areas for agriculture consulting are presented in the table below with examples of projects under each of the specializations. The table also classifies the demand and need of consulting in the domain as high, medium, or low based on discussions with over 50 area experts.

S.No.	Area	Consulting Needs
1	**Agri. Production / Farm consulting**	High
2	**Rural project planning and development consulting** Example: United Nations Development Programme, Uttarakhand	High
3	**Project management** Example: Favorich Mega Food Park	High
4	**Agri Finance consulting (Various ag. Subsidies)** Example: Promotion of Private Investment in Agriculture, Odisha	High

5	**Agriculture Marketing** Example: Marketing Strategies for Organic Produce of Sikkim (Large Cardamom, Turmeric, Ginger, Cymbidium Orchid and Buckwheat)	High
6	**Food processing and Value addition** Example: Detailed project report for Shrimp Processing	High
7	**Agricultural infrastructure (Greenhouse, warehouse, ripening chambers, cold storage) consulting** Example: Setting Up of Controlled Atmospheric Store & Processing Facility in Vikasnagar, Uttarakhand including business plan & primary survey of farmers, traders & markets for EquiCap Asia Pt. Ltd.	High
8	**Modern agriculture (Hydroponics, vertical farming)** Example: Hydroponic DPR for ACME	High
9	**Agri. Tech and precision agriculture** Example: Consulting Assignment for developing the business case of Solar systems with drip through pilots among small holders (sugarcane)	High
10	**Organic production, certification, and marketing** Example: Organic Buckwheat Processing Unit in Sikkim	High
11	**Ag. Research plan development and facilitation** Example: Transaction Advisory Services for Agribusiness Infrastructure Development Investment Program AIDIP under ADB Loan 2669-IND	Moderate
12	**Horticulture and ornamentals** Example: Consulting services for development & management of three orchards at Ramgarh Uttarakhand	Moderate
13	**Irrigation systems and farm water management (Drip, sprinkler, rainwater harvesting systems)**	High
14	**Landscaping and garden development** Example: Landscaping Consultancy for American Embassy Compound Project, Kabul, Afghanistan	Moderate
15	**Food business consulting** Example: DPR on Vodka Bottling in India	High
16	**FPO/Cooperative/SHG establishment and management consulting** Example: Scoping Study and Value Chain Analysis for Identification of Potential Clusters for Value Chain Development	High
17	**Plant protection and disease management**	High
18	**Post-harvest handling and produce management** Example: Setting Up of Integrated Apple Sorting – Grading Waxing & Packing Line of 8 – 10 TPH with CA / Cold Store of 5000 MT (Chambers of 100 – 150 MT) at Rambirpora (Anantnag) and Behrampora (Baramulla) in J&K	High

19.	**Animal Husbandry and Management** Example: DPR for dairy farm and processing centre	Moderate
20.	**Food Licensing and testing** Example: DPR for restaurant food licencing and testing parameters.	High

Based on the sample conducted with 50 industry experts, a score for desirability of consulting services was generated for all of the above 20 areas. The score was further statistically normalized on a scale of 1-10, where 10 is the most desirable. The following infographic (next page) presents the areas in decreasing order of demand for consulting services.


Normalized demand score
Agricultural Project management 10.0
Horticulture and ornamentals 9.5
Agri. Production / Farm consulting 8.4
Food processing and Value addition 7.9
Greenhouse, warehouse, ripening chambers consulting 6.8
Post Harvest handling and produce management 6.3
Agri. Tech and precision agriculture 6.3
Food Licensing and testing 6.3
Ag. Research plan development and facilitation 5.8
Animal Husbandry and Management 5.8
Organic production, certification, and marketing 5.8
Agri Finance consulting (Various ag. Subsidies) 4.7
Landscaping and garden development 4.7
Plant Protection and Disease Management 3.7
Food business consulting 3.7
FPO/Cooperative/SHG establishment & management 2.1
Modern agriculture (Hydroponics, vertical farming) 2.1
Agriculture Marketing 1.6
Irrigation systems and farm water management 0.5
Rural project planning and development consulting 0.0
0.0 1.0 2.0 3.0 4.0 5.0 6.0 7.0 8.0 9.0 10.0

Annexure 1

Details of industry experts contacted for market demand assessment

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Annexure 2

Links to survey materials and raw data

Google form

https://forms.gle/tV9YbDvQ9Axokyrk6

Response sheet

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1RG1V71Xe9gSUdUwcZkTpoTxGKUMrYdSYiuuPM6-EF4/edit?resourcekey#gid=1120477099